



OPPOSITION ANALYSIS

FEYENOORD

A controlled, left-loading possession side that overwhelms you with volume and finishes ruthlessly — but is rarely a counter-attacker itself, and concedes its clearest chances when its build-up is pressed and turned over.

SCOUTING WINDOW

Eredivisie 2022/23 · matchdays 1–10 · 10 matches (7 Aug – 16 Oct 2022)

Source: Opta F24 event data + F7 line-ups · every metric computed from raw event feeds

PREPARED BY

Mats van Eijk

GAME PREPARATION ANALYST — APPLICATION WORK SAMPLE



The 60-second briefing

TEAM PROFILE

Record (this window)	7 W – 2 D – 1 L · 26 scored, 11 conceded
Style	Possession-dominant (58% of passes, range 45–68%); a mid-block, not a press
Shape	5 × 4-2-3-1, 5 × 4-3-3 — the 4-3-3 is sharper & more left-loaded
Attack	18.7 shots & 1.83 xG/game; out-finishes xG by +7.7 (26 goals vs 18.3)
Build-up	Plays through you (10% long balls), Kökçü the hub, loads the LEFT half-space
Where they crack	29% of shots conceded follow a turnover ≤15s — in their own half

FIVE THINGS THAT DECIDE THE GAME

1 · Make it a transition game — they won't

They keep 58% of the ball but took just ONE fast-break shot in 10 games: a control side, not a counter side. A passing contest suits them; repeated transitions do not.

2 · Press their build-up — that's where they crack

29% of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) come within 15s of a Feyenoord turnover, and those losses sit in their own half (avg x=32). Win it high and you get a clear look.

3 · Their damage comes through the LEFT

41% of final-third entries and 58% of crosses come down their left (Hancko & López build, Idrissi isolates, Szymański drifts in). Overload your defensive right side.

4 · Strike early — they own the late game

Their one window where xGA beats xG is 15–30' (2.9 xGA, 4 conceded). After 60' they scored 12 and conceded 1. Land the first blow; don't bank on chasing them late.

5 · Set pieces are live both ways

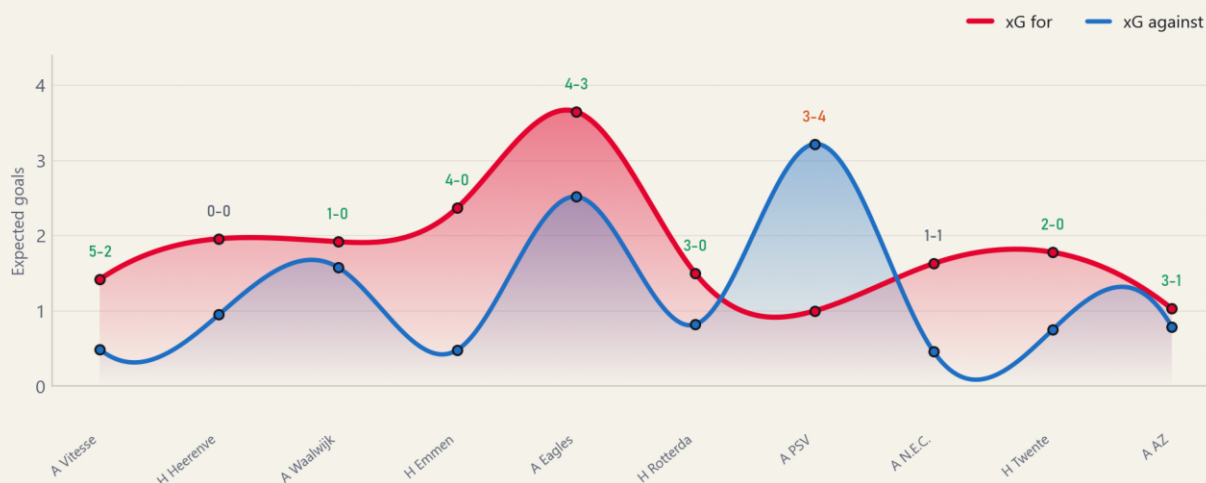
5 set-piece goals scored, 3 conceded. Corners come mostly from the left to the far post (48 of 75) — a moment to defend with numbers and to attack as a real route to goal.

02

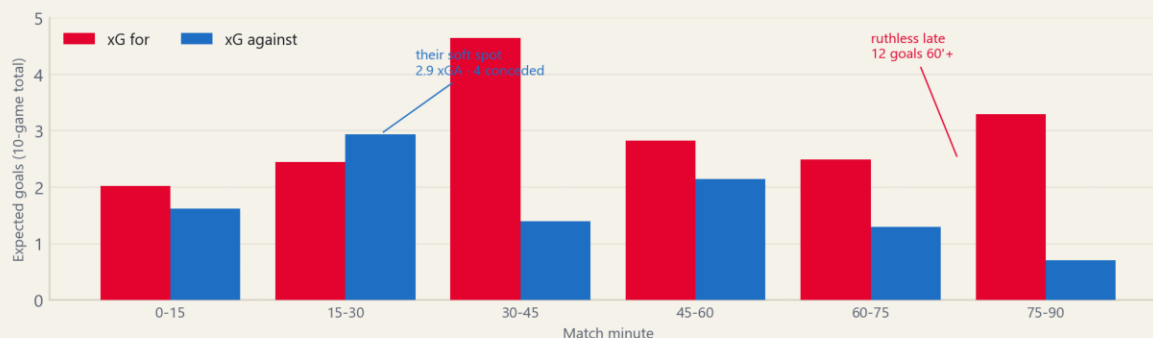


Who they are, and how it's gone

EXPECTED GOALS, MATCH BY MATCH



WHEN THEY HURT YOU, AND WHEN YOU HURT THEM



Dominant, rarely troubled

Seven wins from ten, 26 goals, an xG line above their xGA in eight of ten games. They control matches and out-create opponents — a passing contest favours them.

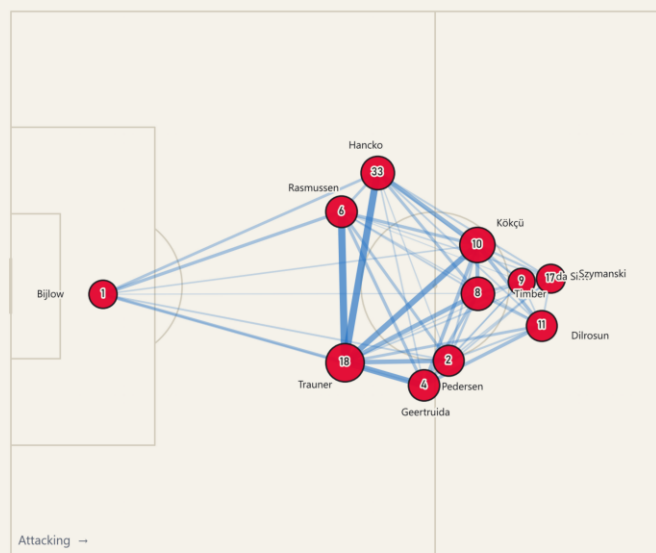
The exceptions are the lesson

The two spikes — the 3-4 loss at PSV (3.2 xGA) and the 4-3 win at Go Ahead (2.5 xGA) — were open, transitional, end-to-end games. That is the template to beat them.

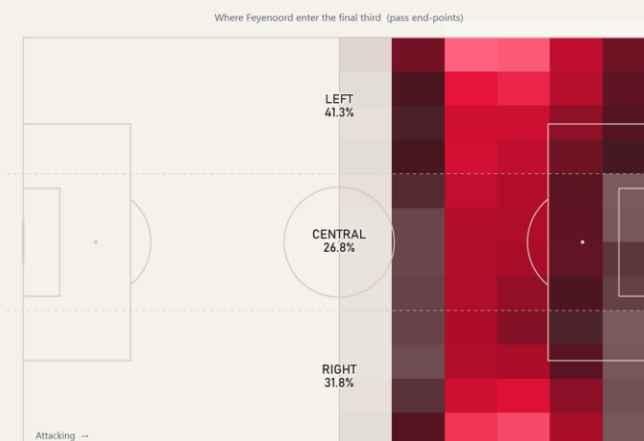
Strike early, fear the late game

Their only window where xGA beats xG is 15–30' (2.9 xGA, 4 conceded). After 60' they scored 12 and conceded 1. Land the first blow.

03



Average on-ball positions (build-up shape) · node = involvement · line = pass volume



58%

OF ALL PASSES

10%

LONG BALLS

22.1

PROGRESSIVE/GAME

18.9

CROSSES/GAME

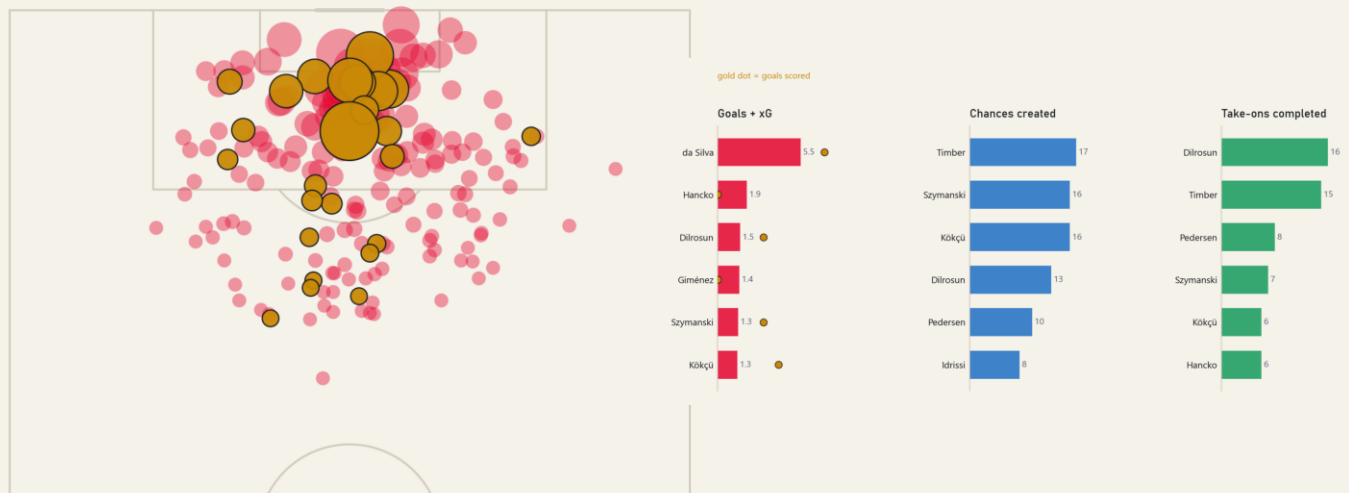
25%

CROSSES DONE

WHAT IT MEANS

- They play through you, not over you — Kökcü (888 touches, 39 progressive passes) drops to set tempo around halfway. Screen the lane back to him and the build-up stalls.
- Verified LEFT bias: 41% of final-third entries and 58% of crosses come from the left (Hancko & López build, Idrissi isolates, Szymański drifts in).
- Volume crossing, modest precision (18.9/game at 25%): a well-populated box and the second ball largely neutralises it.

Where the goals come from



Every shot · size = xG · gold = goals

Top contributors across the window

187

SHOTS

26

GOALS

18.3

xG

+7.7

VS xG

58.3%

IN BOX

28

BIG CHANCES

Manufactured central chances, ruthless finishing

28 big chances in 10 games and 58% of shots inside the box: they work the ball into high-value central areas. They are also out-finishing xG by +7.7 (26 goals from 18.3) — partly a regression risk, but the finishers are real, so the defensive message is concede nothing clear, not 'they'll miss it'.

A spread threat behind one finisher

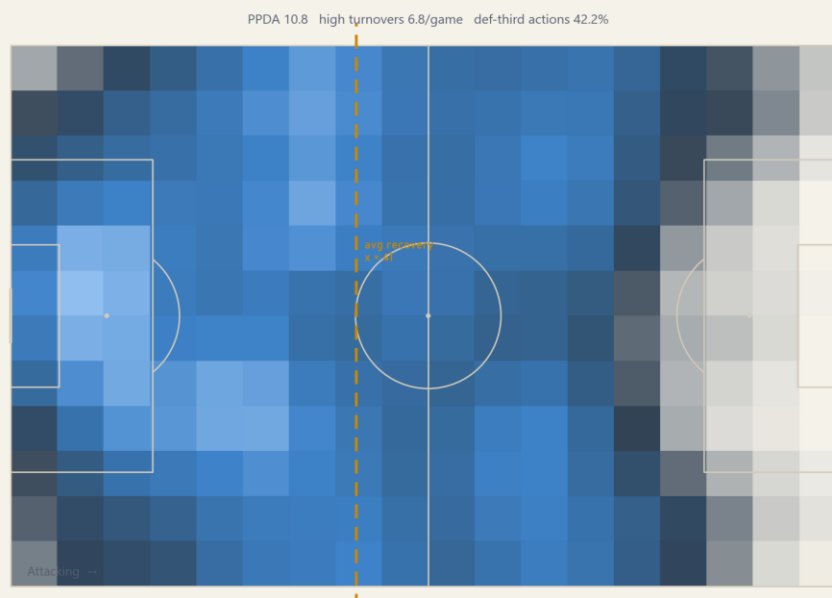
Danilo leads the line and the scoring (7 goals, 5.45 xG); Kökçü adds 4 (incl. penalties), Dilrosun and Szymański 3 each, Timber arriving from deep. Giménez is the like-for-like off the bench and forcing his way in.

Set pieces — a real, repeatable threat

One in five of their shots is from a set piece (39 shots, 5 goals, 5.8 xG). 75 corners, 48 from the LEFT, delivered mostly to the FAR post (only 5% short). Trauner and Hancko attack the ball; Kökçü delivers. Defend the far post with numbers.

05

Their block & their two shapes



10.8

PPDA

x41

AVG RECOVERY

42.2%

ACTIONS DEF THIRD

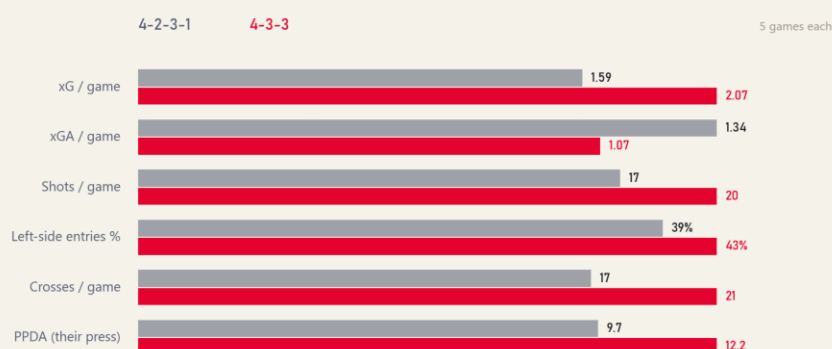
14.5%

ATT THIRD

6.8

HIGH TURNOVERS/G

A TALE OF TWO SHAPES — 5 GAMES EACH



MID-BLOCK, NOT A PRESS

Out of possession they are controlled: PPDA 10.8, only 14.5% of defensive actions in the attacking third, average recovery just inside their own half (x=41), consistent with a mid-block. They invite you in, stay compact, and re-establish possession rather than counter — they took a single fast-break not all window.

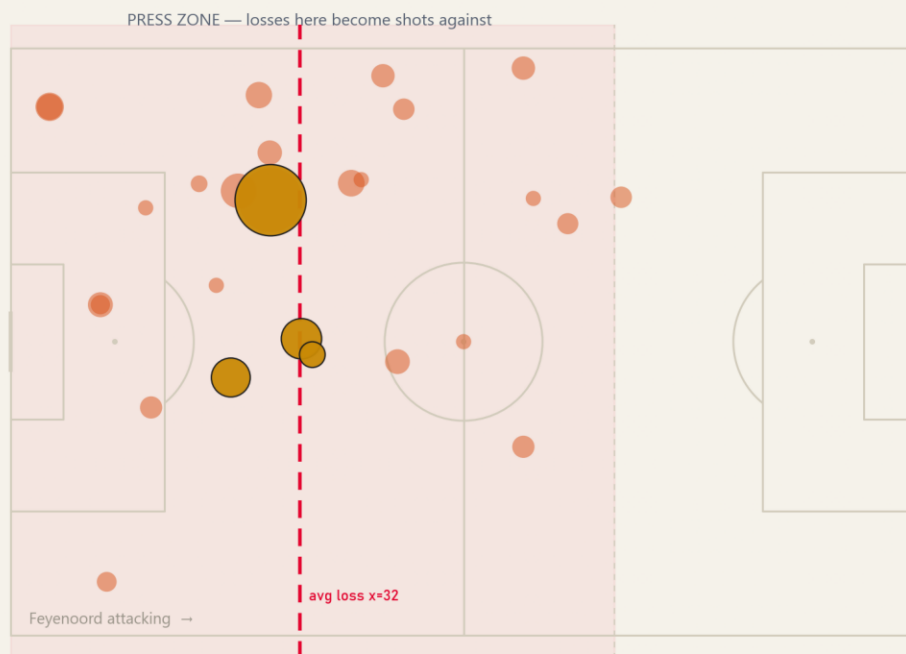
TWO SHAPES

The 4-3-3 is the sharper, more left-loaded, tighter version (2.07 xG & 1.07 xGA/game, 43% left, presses less at PPDA 12.2). The 4-2-3-1 is more balanced but leakier (1.34 xGA/game) and presses higher (PPDA 9.7) — which also means it offers more space in behind to run into.

READ IT IN-GAME

- 4-3-3 = their sharper, more left-loaded shape (2.07 xG, 43% left, 1.07 xGA) and presses less (PPDA 12.2) — build patiently, double the left.
- 4-2-3-1 = more balanced but leakier (1.34 xGA) and presses higher (PPDA 9.7) — bait the press, release runners early into the space behind.

How to hurt Feyenoord



Feyenoord ball-losses that became a shot against within 15s · gold = led to a goal

29%

SHOTS FROM TURNS

28

TRANSITION SHOTS

3.88

TRANSITION XGA

x32

AVG LOSS (THEIR HALF)

11

GOALS CONCEDED

THREE WAYS TO HURT THEM

Press their build-up — don't sit off

29% of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) come within 15s of a turnover, and those losses are in THEIR OWN half (avg x=32). Trigger the press on the pass back to Trauner/Bijlow and screen Kökçü — this is the single clearest route to a chance.

Make it transitional, and strike early

Their only sub-par window is 15–30' (2.9 xGA, 4 conceded); after 60' they are ruthless (12 goals, 1 against). Take an early lead and keep the game open — they barely counter (1 fast-break shot all window).

Win the box on set pieces

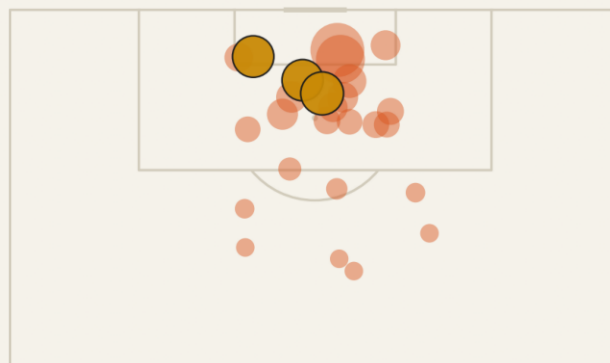
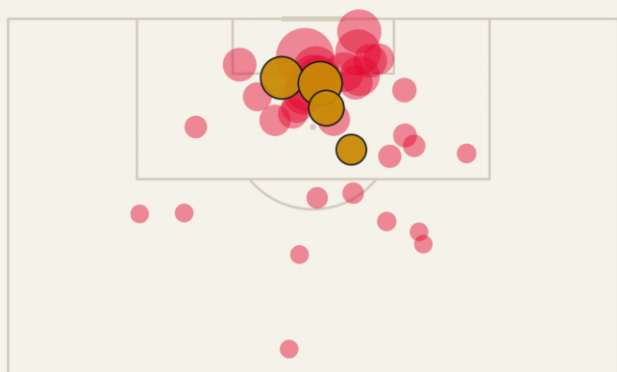
Three set-piece goals conceded in ten games. Their crossing lands only 25% — defend the far post with numbers, then attack their box: a genuine, repeatable route to goal.

Honesty check: ~27% of their xGA comes from one game (PSV). The transition edge is real but partly concentrated — treat it as a lever to confirm on tape, not a guarantee.

Live at both ends

THREAT • 39 shots / 5 goals / 5.8 xG

CONCEDED • 26 shots / 3 goals / 3.1 xG



5

SP GOALS FOR

3

SP GOALS AGAINST

75

CORNERS

48/27

LEFT/RIGHT

5%

SHORT

WHAT THEY DO

One in five of their shots is from a set piece (39 shots, 5 goals, 5.8 xG). 75 corners, 48 from the LEFT, delivered mostly to the FAR post (only 5% short). Trauner and Hancko attack the ball; Kökçü delivers. Defend the far post with numbers.

DEFEND IT / ATTACK IT

- DEFEND: corners come mostly from their left to the far post (48 of 75, only 5% short). Load the far post, put bodies on Trauner & Hancko, win the first contact.
- ATTACK: they concede 3 set-piece goals in 10 games and their open-play crossing is only 25% accurate— overload the box, target the far post and the second phase.
- RECYCLE: with their full-backs committed to attacking corners, our cleared set pieces are a transition trigger — first outlet runs immediately.

Who to plan around

Orkun Kökçü

10 · Deep pivot

The hub: 888 touches, team-high 39 progressive passes, 16 chances created, 4 goals, plus penalties and corners. Receives around halfway, left-centre. DENY THE TURN — screen the pass back to him and stop him facing our goal.

39

PROG PASSES

16

CHANCES

888

TOUCHES

Quinten Timber

8 · Box-to-box

Best 1v1 in the side (27 take-ons, 56% won) and team-high 17 chances created from deep, 924 minutes. Arrives in the box (26 box touches). Track his forward runs — he turns control into penetration.

17

CHANCES

56%

TAKE-ON WIN

27

TAKE-ONS

Dávid Hancko

33 · Left centre-back

Engine of the left build-up: #2 progressive passer, 1.9 xG from set pieces, 958 minutes. He steps into midfield — and the channel he vacates is exactly the space to attack in transition.

31

PROG PASSES

1.9

SET-PIECE XG

958

MINUTES

Sebastian Szymański

17 · Attacking mid

Between the lines, drifts left: 3 goals, 16 chances created, take-ons at 50%. Assign a midfielder to pick him up in the half-space before he turns.

3

GOALS

16

CHANCES

50%

TAKE-ON WIN

Javairô Dilrosun

11 · Roaming forward

High-volume dribbler — 46 take-ons but only 35% won, roaming central/right (y=43), team-high 49 box touches, 3 goals. Containable: show him inside, deny the box entry rather than dive in.

46

TAKE-ONS

35%

WON

49

BOX TOUCHES

Danilo

9 · Striker

Main finisher: 7 goals from 5.45 xG, plays on the last shoulder. Disciplined depth control from our centre-backs is essential. Giménez is the like-for-like off the bench.

7

GOALS

5.45

XG

8

STARTS

The concrete recommendations

WITH THE BALL

- Win-it-and-go from their HALF: the moment we turn them over in their build-up, attack — 29% of the shots they concede start exactly here.
- Front-load the threat: target the 15–30' window (their only negative-xG period) and don't plan to chase them after 60', when they are ruthless.
- When set, attack the space behind Hancko's steps with a runner from our right.
- Treat set pieces as a primary route to goal — they concede from them; rehearse far-post and second-phase routines.

WITHOUT THE BALL

- Press the build-up with triggers: jump when it goes back to Trauner/Bijlow or square to the left-back; screen the lane into Kökçü so he can't turn.
- Force them to cross from deep down their left, then defend the box with numbers — win first AND second contact (only 25% of crosses land).
- No isolated 1v1s for our right-back vs the left overload; the winger tracks the high left-back.
- Control our line in a mid-block; they barely counter (1 fast-break shot), so the risk is sustained pressure, not balls in behind — stay compact and patient.

IN-GAME SCENARIOS

If they line up 4-3-3

Their sharper, more left-loaded shape (2.07 xG, 43% left). Double the left side, and use a spare man to jump Kökçü; they press less here (PPDA 12.2) so we can build.

If they line up 4-2-3-1

Leakier (1.34 xGA) and they press higher (PPDA 9.7) — more space in behind. Bait the press and release runners early into the channels.

If we lead

Stay in the block, manage set pieces, keep press triggers on their build-up; don't drop so deep we invite the sustained pressure they thrive on.

First 30' / after a goal

Their soft window is 15–30'. Start fast and physical, take an early lead — the late game (60'+: 12 goals, 1 conceded) belongs to them.

10

What I'd tell the players, day by day

How I would feed this into the week — the right information, to the right people, in the right format, at the right time. Players get less, sharper and more visual as the match nears; never more than three messages a day on the pitch.

MD-4 · Staff alignment

Full dossier to the head coach and assistants. Agree the game-model response: press triggers on their build-up, block height, set-piece plans, the early-game intent. Lock the 3–4 headline messages we will drip to players. No player video yet — align the staff story first.

MD-3 · Team — out of possession

Squad meeting (8–10 min). One theme: how they build and where they crack. Clip reel — Kōkçü dropping, the left overload, turnovers that became shots. The ask: 'press the build-up, screen Kōkçü, force them left, win the box.' Back line + keeper unit on the in-behind picture.

MD-2 · Team — in possession & transition

Our route to goal: clips of turnovers in their half and the space behind Hancko's steps; train transition-to-finish drills mirroring their shape. Wingers/full-backs get a clip pack on their direct opponent (Idrissi, the high left-back, Pedersen).

MD-1 · Set pieces & individuals

Set-piece meeting both ways: our far-post marking vs Trauner/Hancko; our attacking routines vs their box defence. Hand out individual clips (60–90s) to the players who need them — personal, on their direct duel. Keep it light and confident.

MD · Reminders only

No new information. A one-page visual in the dressing room: the 3 keys (press their build-up / force left & win the box / strike early). 30-second individual reminders. Live: flag from the bench whether they're in 4-3-3 or 4-2-3-1 and adjust per the plan.

11



HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Every figure and number is computed directly from the raw Opta F24 event feeds and F7 line-ups for Feyenoord's first ten Eredivisie 2022/23 matches — no third-party aggregations. The pitch convention is stated and verified: $y > 66.7$ is the attacking LEFT (cross-checked against known left- and right-sided players). Expected goals (xG) uses a transparent distance-and-angle geometry model with header and set-piece adjustments, calibrated so the mean across all shots in the sample matches a league-typical ~ 0.11 ; Feyenoord's own shots average 0.098 — high volume at slightly below-average quality. Goal totals are quoted as match results (26 for, 11 against); the shot-event feed attributes 27/10, the small difference being own goals. Transition chances link each opponent shot to the Feyenoord ball-loss within 15 seconds before it.

WHAT I'D ADD WITH MORE TIME / DATA

- Ten matches is a tendency sample, not a verdict — one game (PSV) drives $\sim 27\%$ of the xGA, so the transition weakness is real but partly concentrated.
- Pass-network positions are average on-ball locations (a build-up shape, not a snapshot XI); edges are inferred from successive same-team events.
- With tracking/possession data I'd quantify pressing triggers, line height and off-ball runs; with the full season I'd separate stable patterns from small-sample noise and lock the XI.

- Every figure would ship with linked video — each data point one click from the moment on tape.

WHY THIS ROLE, WHY THIS WAY

Opposition analysis is only useful if it changes behaviour on the pitch. My priority was to move from a large, raw event dataset to a small number of clear, evidence-backed messages a coach can install and a player can remember — structure, patterns, vulnerabilities, key players and scenarios, each tied to a concrete action and a way to communicate it through the week. That translation — done consistently, accurately and on time — is the job.

PREPARED BY

Mats van Eijk

Feyenoord opposition analysis · application work sample

12